

display using Spectral C6 HDR2000 Colourimeter, Videoforge Pro pattern generator, and Calman Ultimate software. The Cinema mode is tuned for viewing in a causal viewing environment and the professional mode is most accurate and meant for dark environments.

The great thing is that the colour temperature in both the Professional mode and Cinema mode is close to standard D65. The colour accuracy in both the SDR and HDR mode is excellent on Bravia 7. Since the TV supports auto-cal, enthusiasts can calibrate it further for a tighter response.

In SDR, we recorded an average delta error of just 1.8 and a maximum delta error of 4.3 out of the box, which is indeed impressive. The maximum brightness is limited in SDR and goes up to 500 to 600 nits which is because SDR content is mastered for 100 nits and it won't make any sense to go any brighter.

Skin tones are accurate and the TV can render dark and mixed SDR scenes rather well. Critical memory colours like skin tones, colours of the sky and foliage are rendered accurately.

The TV supports Dolby Vision and HDR10. Dark scenes in HDR are rendered beautifully. The TV also handled high dynamic range scenes with both bright highlights and shadows like the above scene from Crimlar Records nicely. In HDR10 we recorded an average Delta Error of just 2.2, which is above average. Once again the movie mode is warmer than the standard D65 out of the box. Peak brightness can go close to 2000 nits in HDR on a 10% window and the full field brightness goes up to 800 nits. Sony Bravia 7 has a Prime Calibrated Mode that is enabled by default. The mode may appear dim but is actually quite accurate. There is also a Netflix Calibrated Mode which isn't enabled by default. Motion clarity felt really impressive while watching content and also while gaming. Sony also does a great job with upscaling legacy content.

Overall, if you are looking for reliable colour accuracy out of the box, the Bravia 7 Mini LED TV won't disappoint.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Sony Bravia 7 is a snappy TV as you'd expect at this price point. The content we played almost instantly switched to high-resolution settings and playback controls worked smoothly. We did not notice any unexpected jitters while switching between apps. The XR processor is backed by 32GB of storage, which gives some assurance that the performance shall remain snappy after a period of use.

Casting and screen mirroring work seamlessly across Android and iOS devices since the TV supports Apple Airplay, Apple Homekit and Chromecast Built-in. The far-field microphones work well and the Bravia 7 could consistently respond to our voice prompts.

The software is based on Google TV and is perhaps the best version of Google TV that we have experienced. Sony has invested considerable effort in offering a wide range of customization options on the Bravia 7, with default settings optimized to provide the best experience for everyday users who may prefer not to risk toggling the wrong options. So, both casual viewers and tech enthusiasts can enjoy a tailored experience, with the flexibility to tweak further if desired.

There are several preloaded Sony apps, which are well-designed. The Sony Bravia Core app is now available in India and offers a vast selection of titles from Sony Pictures, including some with IMAX Enhanced with 80Mbps Pure Stream. Bravia 7 Users will also get 10 free credits to add content to their library and stream in high quality for 24 months. Additionally, you can register your Bravia TV to enjoy a three-month free subscription to Sony Liv.

GAMING AND AUDIO

We tested the gaming prowess of the Sony Bravia 7 with Sony PS5 and games like Ghost of Tsushima, Witcher 3 and Spiderman 2. The TV has a low latency game mode and supports HDMI 2.1 gaming features like ALLM. The gameplay was perfectly smooth. The HDR impact fell a tad short of what you'd get

on an OLED TV, but it was still pretty great for an LED LCD TV.

Sony has always done well with audio quality on its premium TVs. The audio from the Bravia 7 is well-balanced, rich and vibrant. The soundstage is wide and dialogue clarity is great. Sony's Acoustic Audio Tuning feature offers the option to calibrate audio specifically for your room setup, tailoring the sound to your unique space. In our testing, however, the difference was subtle, though it may provide a more noticeable enhancement in rooms with unique acoustics.

SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

The Sony Bravia 7 Mini LED TV strikes a compelling balance between performance and pricing for those looking for a 65-inch or larger TV in the premium segment. With its refined mini LED backlighting and Sony's XR image processing, this TV offers high peak brightness for an impactful HDR experience along with excellent colour accuracy. You also get rich and clear audio, along with well-designed software. Solid build quality and a gaming experience that hits the mark, are other perks that make Bravia 7 very appealing.

The closest competitors to the Bravia 7 are LG QNED 90T and Samsung Neo QNED 85D.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Model: K-65XR70 | Display: 65-inch Mini LED backlight, XR Triluminous Pro (Quantum Dots), Local Dimming | Panel Type: VA LCD | Display Resolution: 3840 x 2160 – 4K UHD | Panel Refresh Rate: 120Hz | Supported HDR Formats: HDR10, HLG, Dolby Vision | Speakers: 40W, Acoustic Multi-audio, Sound positioning tweeter | Audio formats: Dolby Atmos, Dolby Audio, DTS Digital Surround, DTS Express, DTS-HD Master Audio, DTS-HD High Resolution Audio, DTS:X | Software: Google TV with Sony customizations (Android TV 12) | Screen Mirroring: Chromecast built-in, Apple AirPlay | HDMI Ports: 4 HDMI ports (2 HDMI 2.1) | Processor: XR Processor | Storage: 32GB | Other connectivity options: 2x USB ports (500mA, 900mA), Dual-band Wi-Fi 6, Bluetooth 5.3, AV, RF, Ethernet, headphone

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